

## NURTURE AND OUR ENVIRONMENT

The first step in discovering your Financial Phenotype is to understand the role of nurture and your environment. It's important to understand that nurture is so much more than our family unit, our childhood experiences and how we were raised. It encompasses our environment, culture, life experiences and more.

Now, I could make this a simple book about Money Types and ignore the influence of our Money Stories and our Money Environments, but that would be akin to starting a book in the middle but missing the beginning and the end. Sure, you might develop an understanding of a person's behaviour based on their personality, but you won't understand what has shaped them and whether that has created negative, positive or neutral outcomes. Or it would be like eating a bowl of plain, unseasoned and unsauced pasta for dinner. Sure, it might satisfy your hunger, but it's missing a vital companion.

That's why we're starting our conversation here with understanding our Money Environments and Money Stories.

Over the decades, researchers have studied the interplay of nature, nurture and our life experiences and the impact on our investing and spending habits. To keep the Freudians among us happy, let's start with our childhood and life experiences. As someone who grew up in a working-class, blue-collar community, I've often wondered whether being born in another suburb or going to the 'right school' would have made a difference to me financially. Or would it have quickened my financial success?